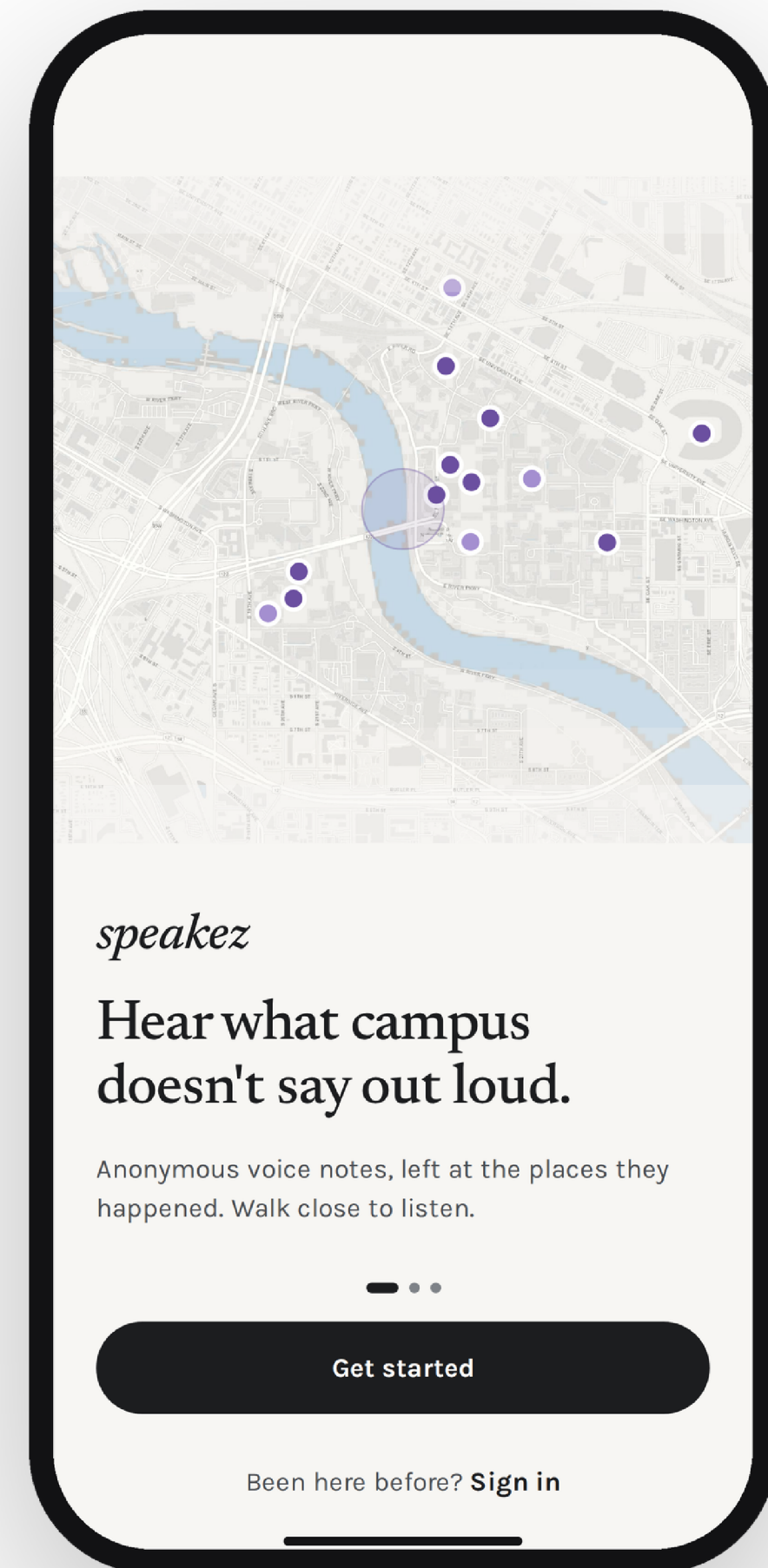


Explore and build a usable solution for a problem students frequently face.

OUR ANSWER

speakez
BY TEAM WAKEHAVEN



INTRODUCING
speakez

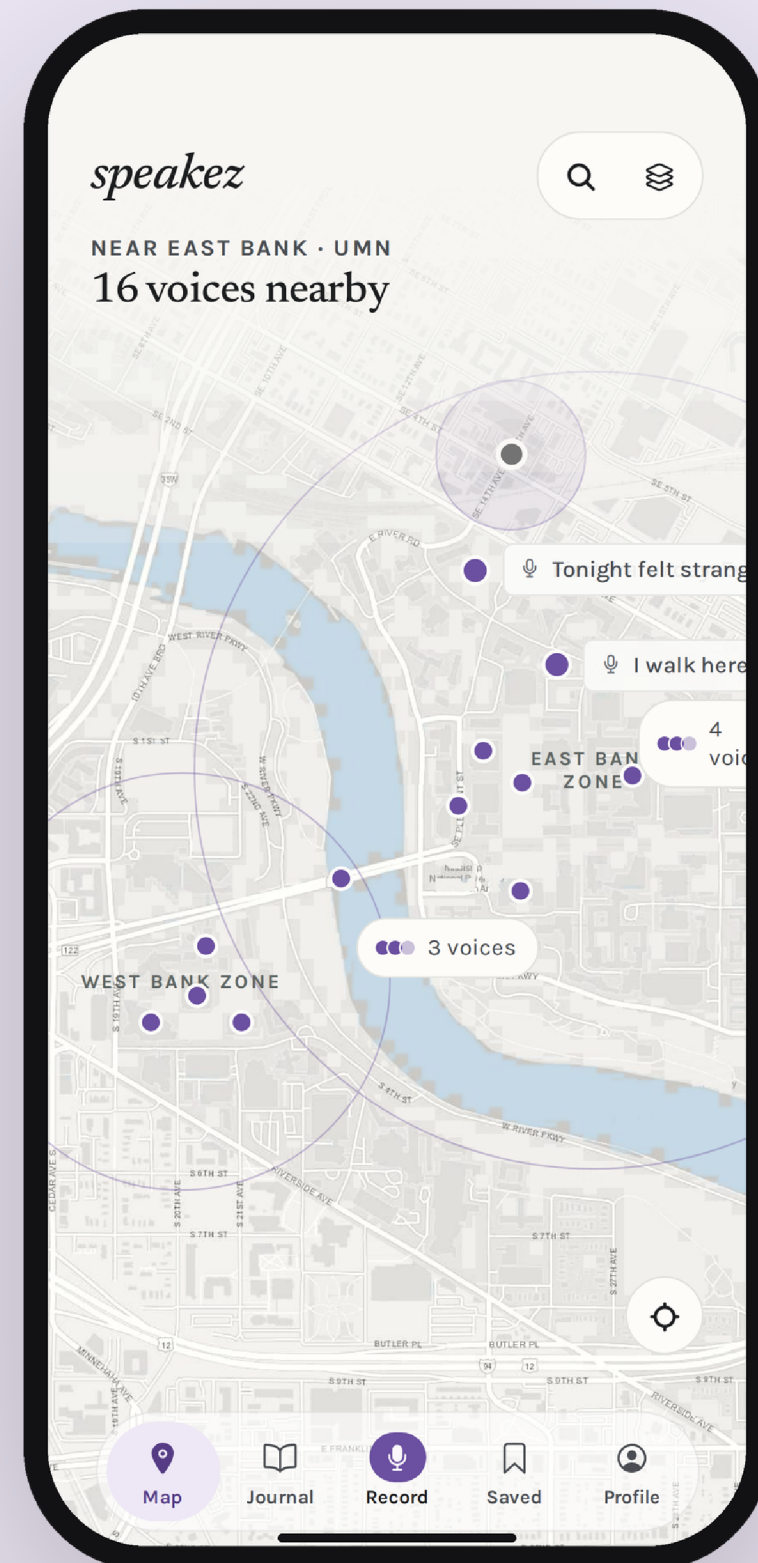
Two ways to finally say it.



01 • THE MAP

Share it
where it
happened.

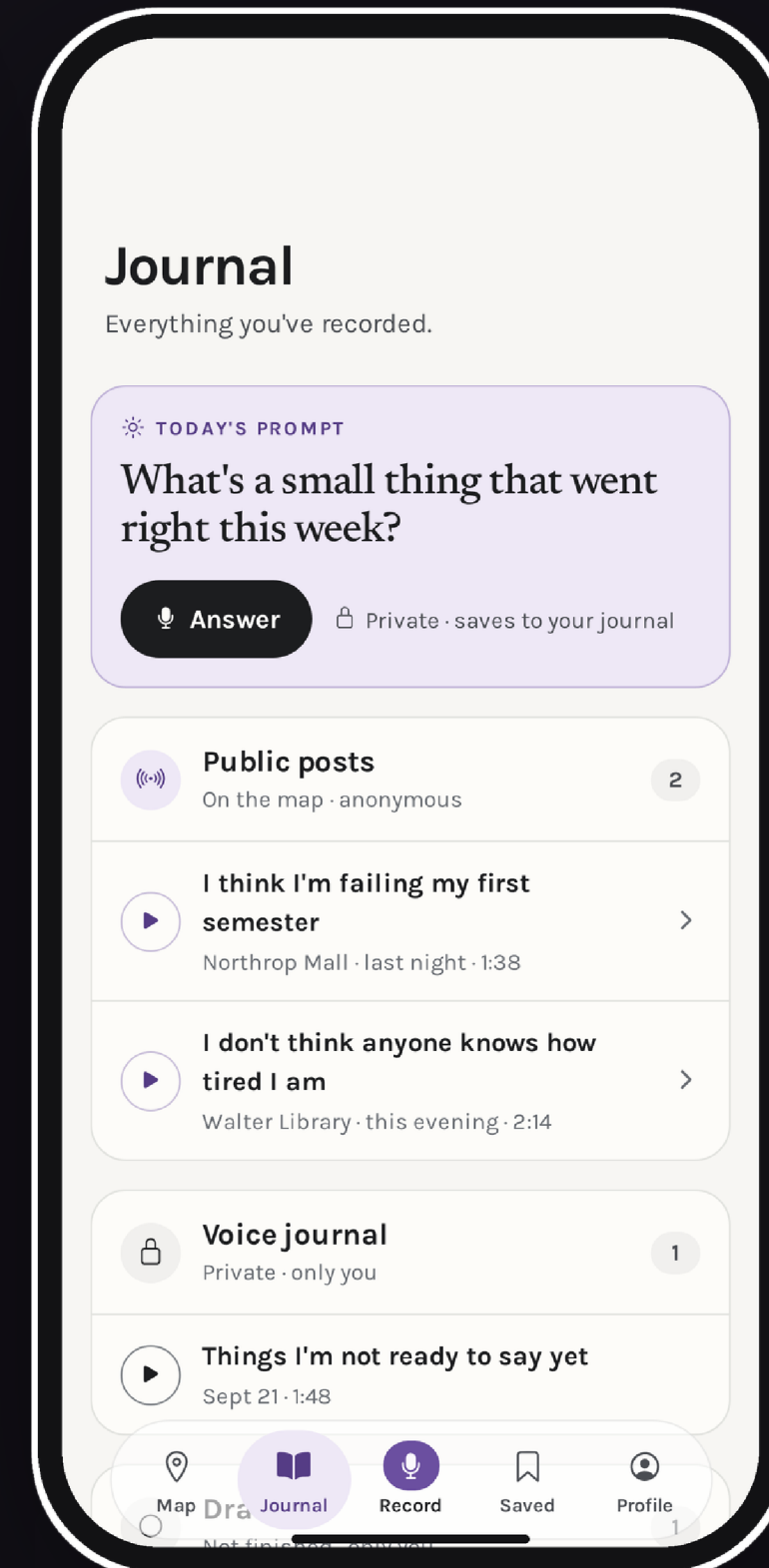
Public, anonymous voice notes
pinned to campus. Be in the
area to hear them.



02 • THE JOURNAL

Keep it just
for you.

A private voice journal you can
add to anytime, with a daily
prompt when you need a
nudge. Nobody else ever hears
it.



People open up when someone asks and listens.

612 Unscripted sets up two chairs on campus with one sign: “What's on your mind?” UMN students sit down and share what they're carrying.

52%

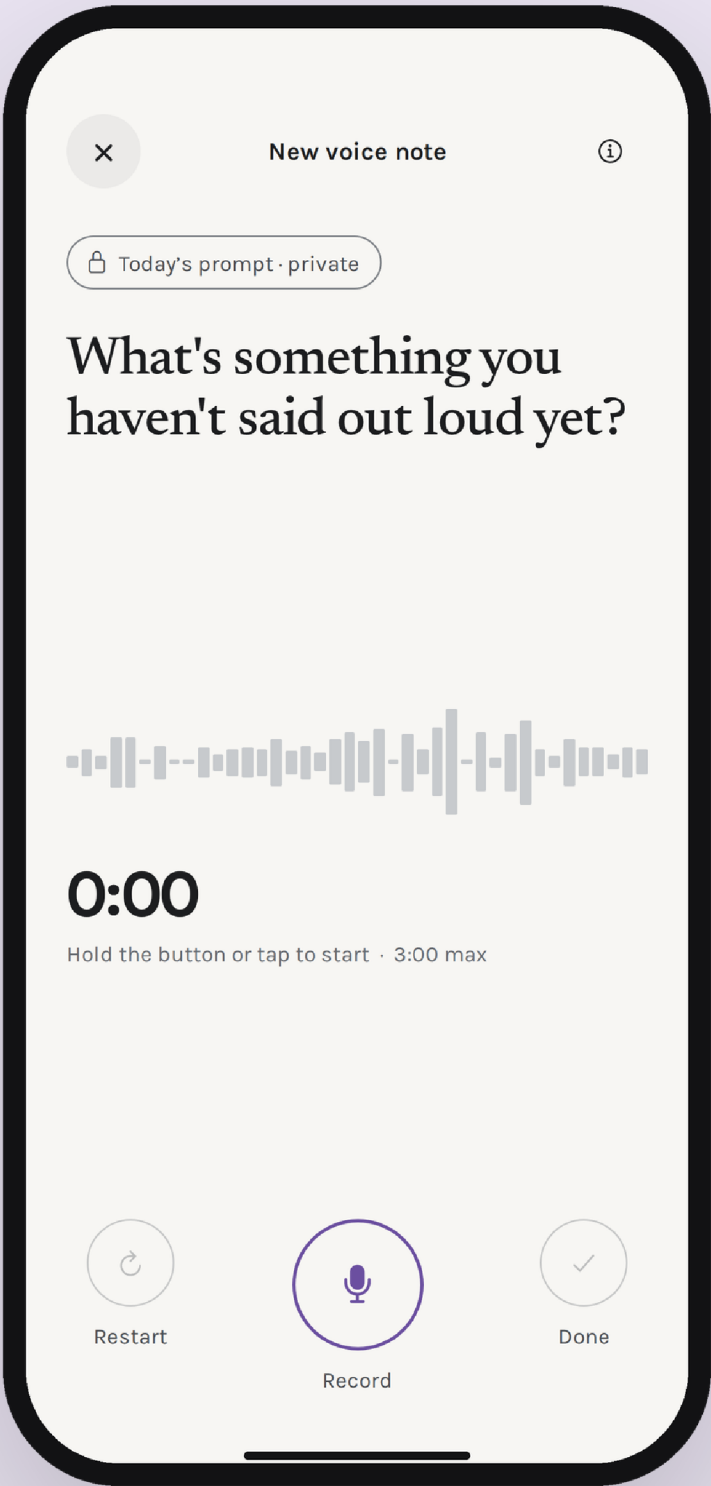
of college students
report feeling lonely

48%

say talking to a peer made
them more open to support



612 Unscripted • youtube.com/@612Unscripted



A map of voices across campus.

Record up to 3 minutes, right where it happened.

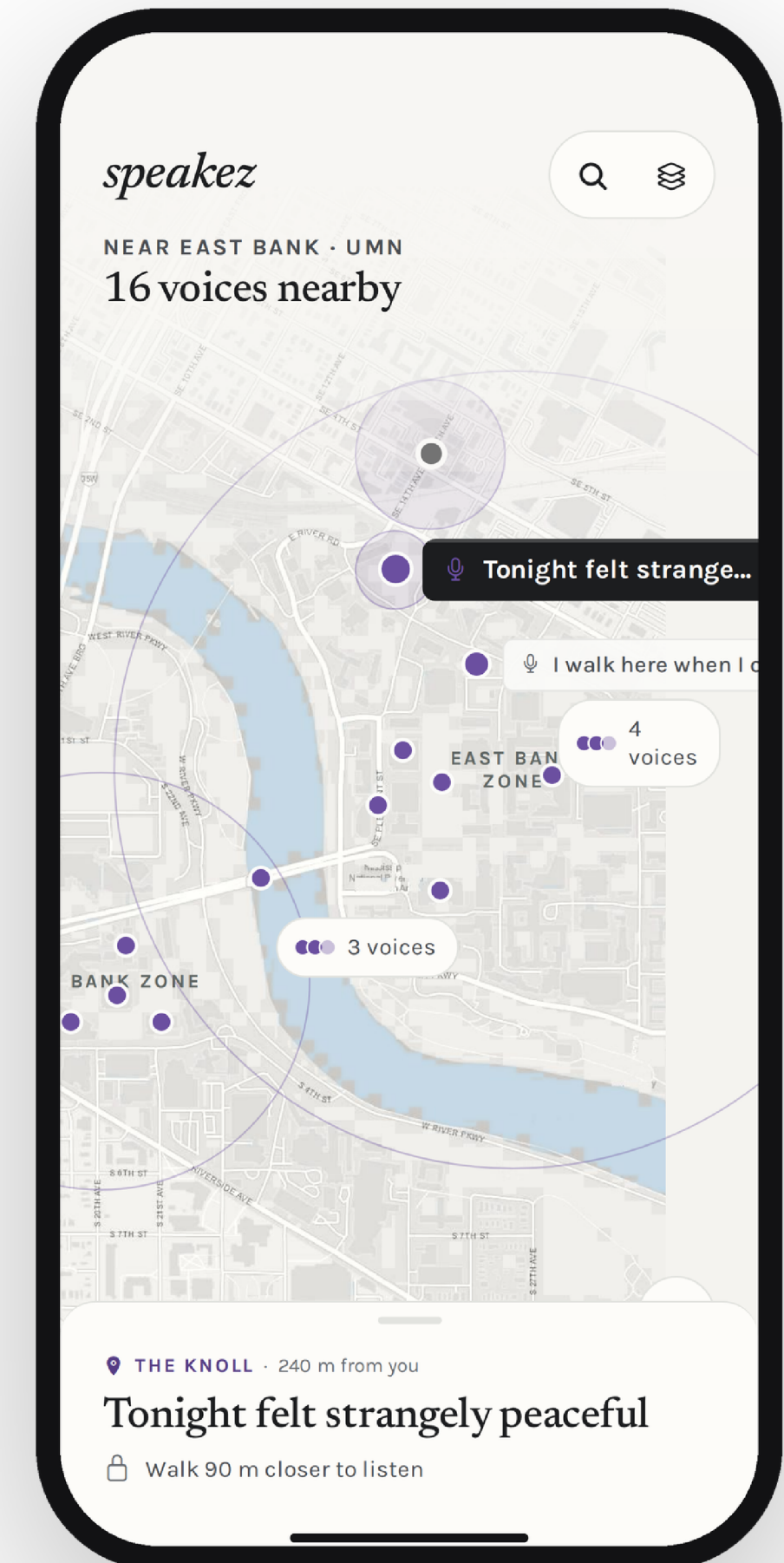
The note lives at that landmark with no author and no profile.

Be in the area to unlock it.

The server checks you're nearby before sending any audio.

No followers, no likes, no counts.

A voice, a place and whoever comes by next.



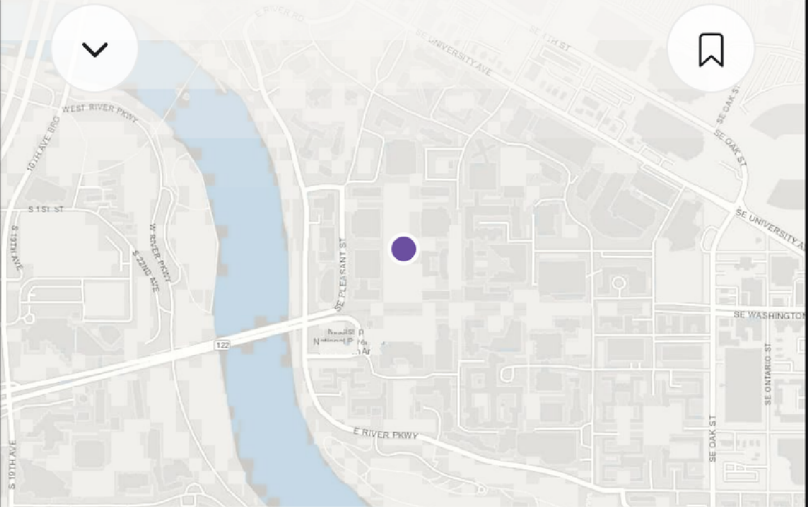
NORTHROP MALL • THIS MORNING

“One yes changes everything.”

A senior applying to master's research programs asked the campus for advice after every no. Students answered with tips each time. Then this.

- FEB • APPLICATION #1 • 14 replies
“First program said no. Any tips for reworking a research statement?”
- APR • APPLICATION #2 • 21 replies
“Second no, but the feedback helped. What made your application stand out?”
- SEPT • APPLICATION #4 • 33 replies
“Round four. Taking everyone's advice and trying a new angle.”
- TODAY • ACCEPTED • 68 replies
“Four applications later, I got into a master's research program.”

TECHNICAL EXECUTION



NORTHROP MALL

Four applications later, I got into a master's research program

Anonymous student · 2 min listen · Left this morning

0:00 / 1:42

Senior year, I asked for advice on these steps after every no. You all sent tips, perspective and a lot of encouragement.

This morning my research advisor pulled me aside in Keller and showed me the acceptance. I came straight here to say thank you.

REPLIES

Let the campus cheer you on.

Anyone around the same spot can answer with their own voice. One note grows into a thread of students who have been there too.

Hear how someone's story lands.

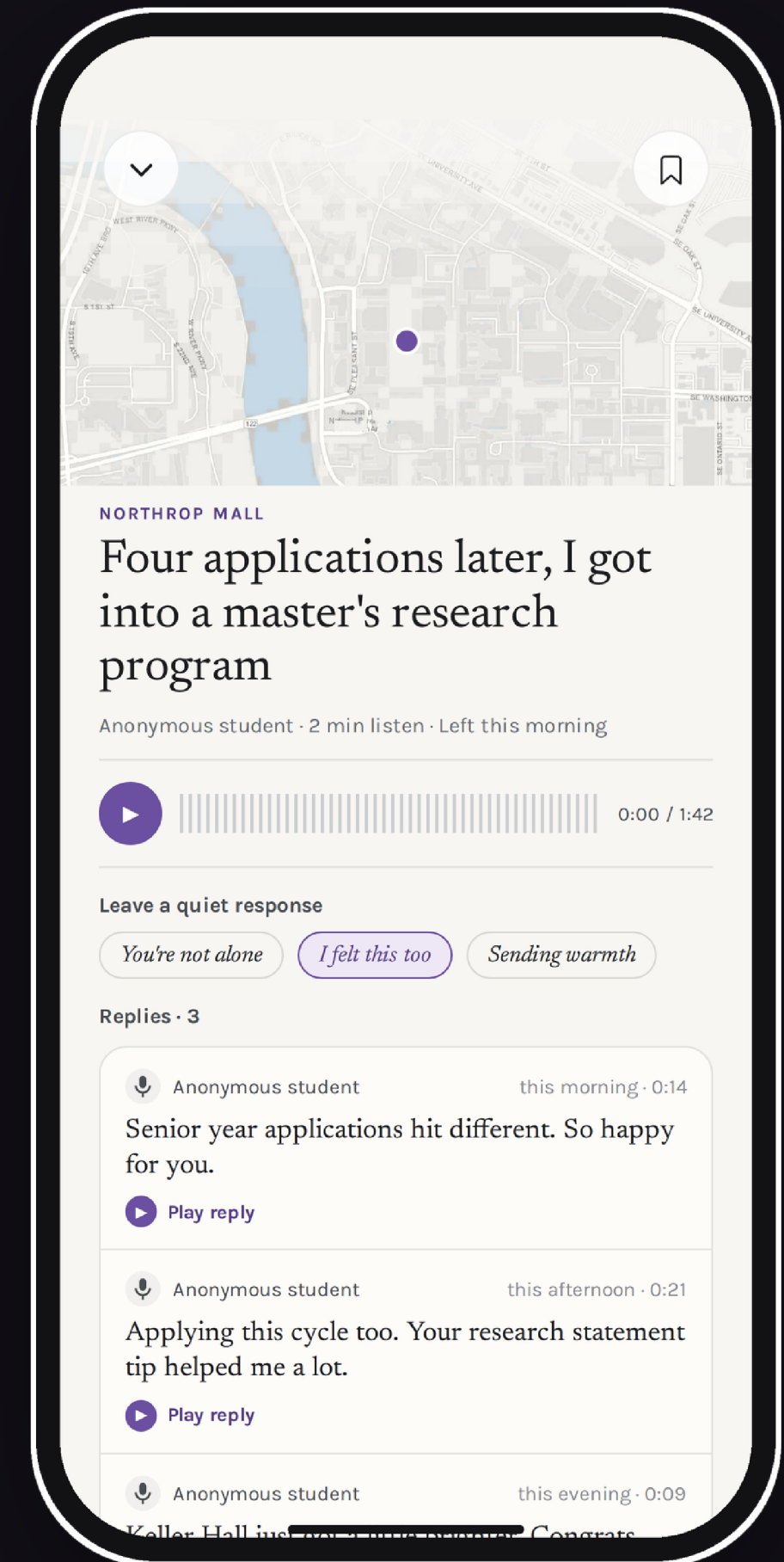
Replies stack under the note in order, so you can hear who it reached.

Feel connected to a place.

Every voice in the thread was right where you are.

Cheer someone on in one tap.

You're not alone. I felt this too. Sending warmth.



HOW A NOTE IS MADE

Say it where it happened.

Tap record and talk for up to three minutes.

Audio goes straight to our transcription queue.

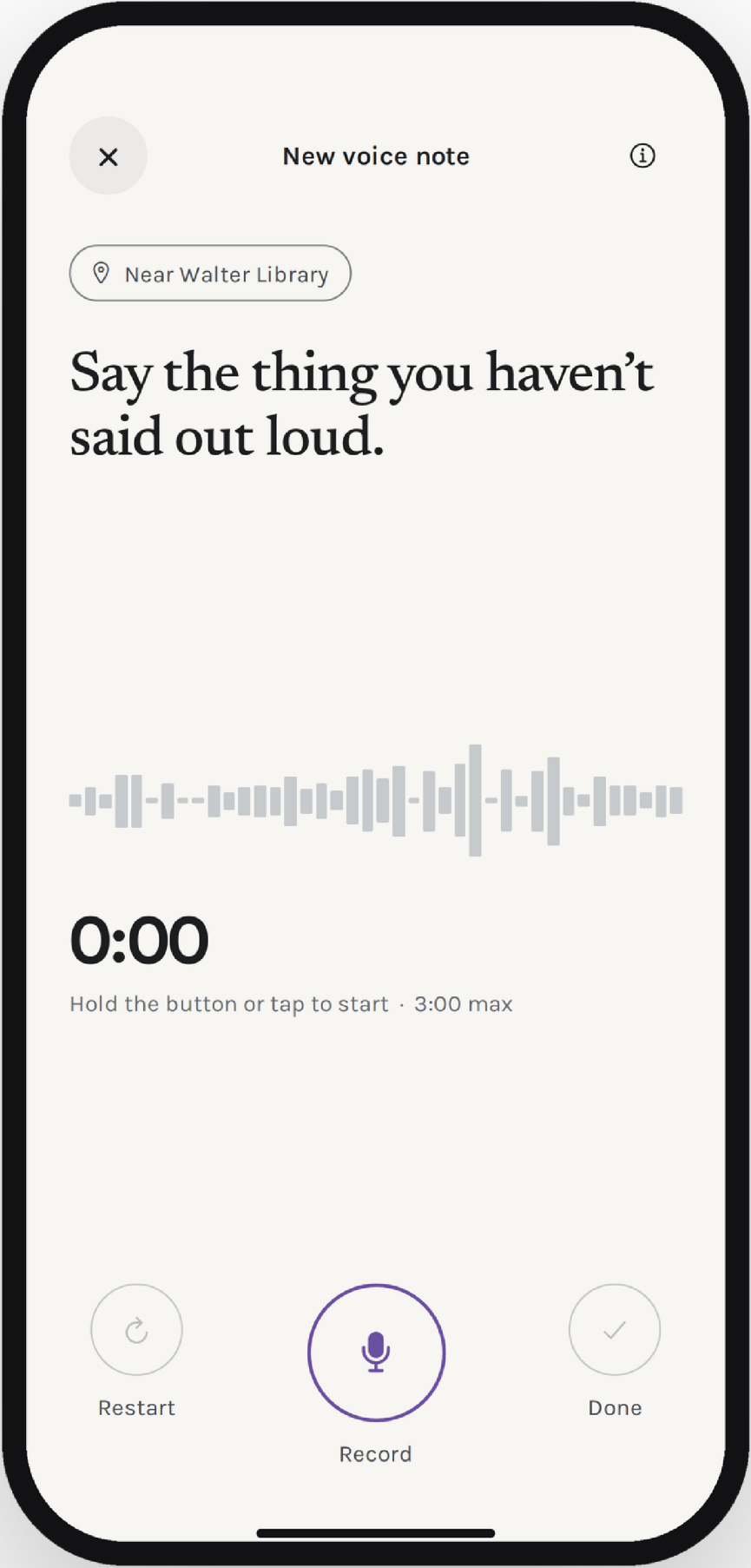
Speech AI writes the transcript and a title.

NVIDIA Parakeet adds word timings for read-along playback.

Pick the map, your journal or a draft.

Review the title and cut any sentence before it posts.

TECHNICAL EXECUTION



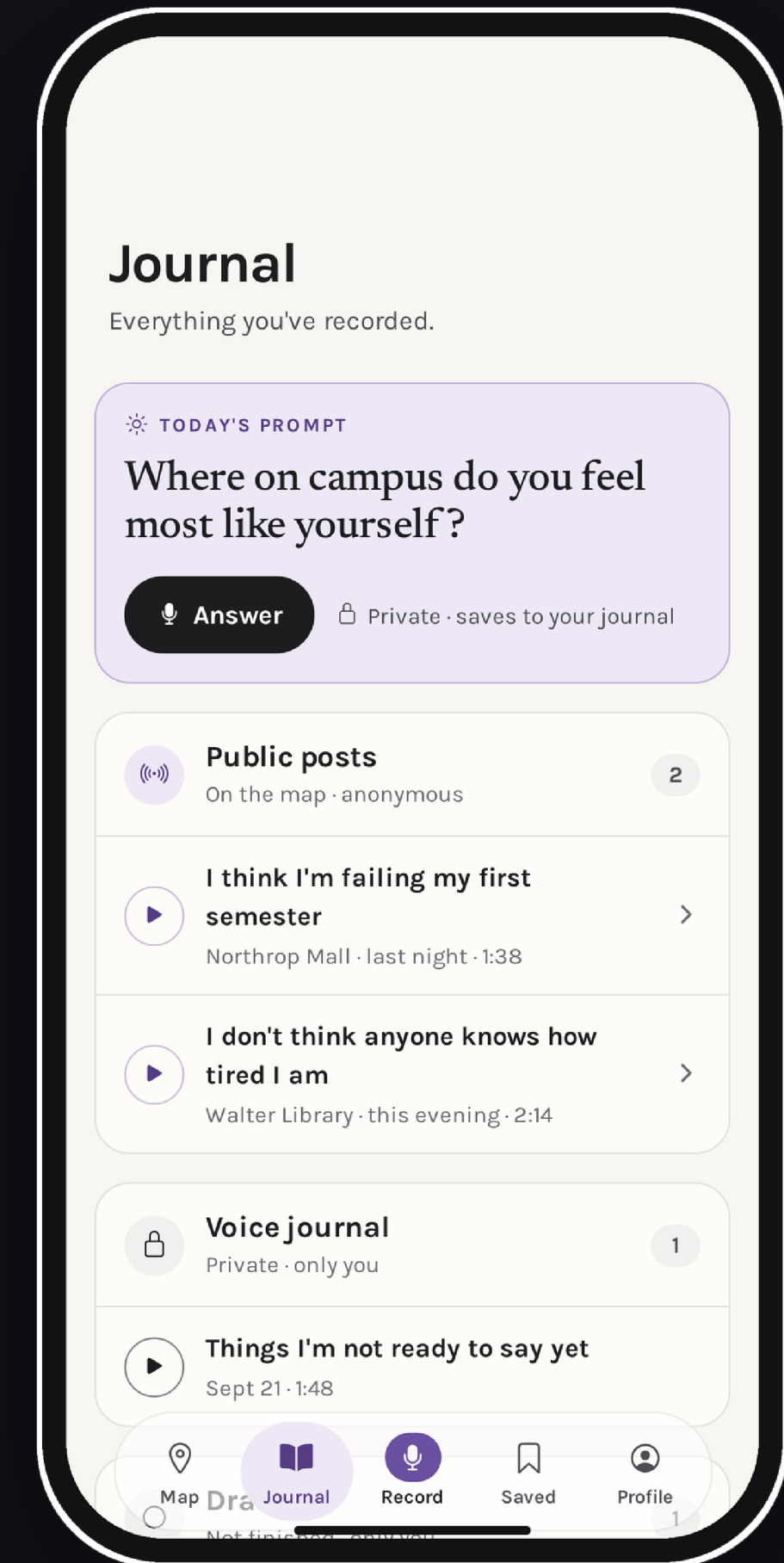
One question a day for the whole campus.

Journal anytime. Every midnight the whole campus gets the same prompt as a nudge. Answers save to your private voice journal, and the database refuses to put them on the map.

Where on campus do you feel most like yourself?

What's a small thing that went right this week?

What are you looking forward to, even a little?



Anonymous by design.

Your email isn't kept.

We verify @umn.edu once, then keep only a one-way hash, so a note can't be traced back to you.

Your exact location isn't saved.

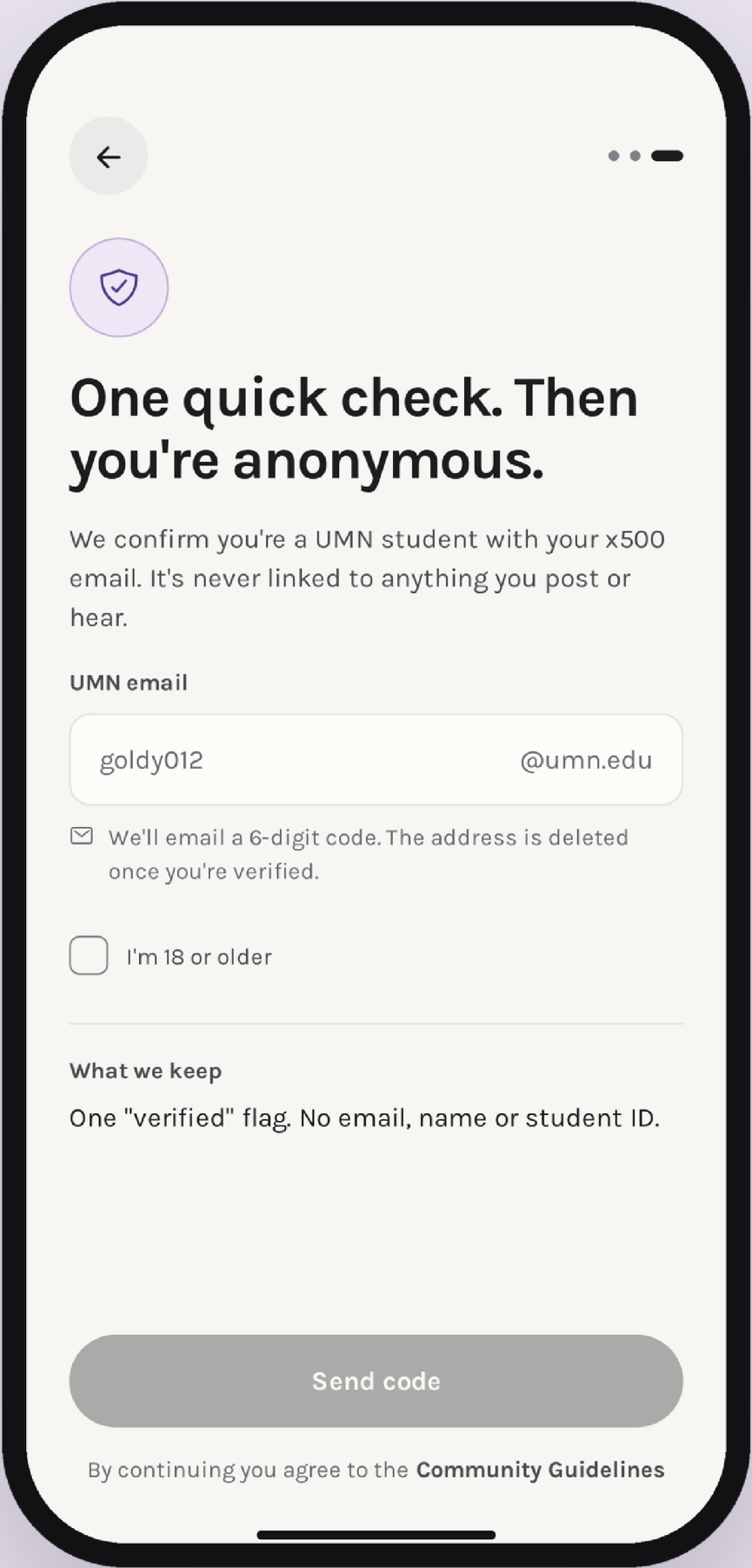
Notes are pinned to a landmark. Your position is only used to check you're nearby.

Voice notes are stored without your name.

Audio plays through short-lived signed links, and notes fade from the map after 30 days.

No timestamps that give you away.

“This evening” instead of “7:42 pm”.



SAFETY

Every note is checked before it goes live.

A versioned safety gate reads every transcript.

Drafts only go live after the gate clears them.

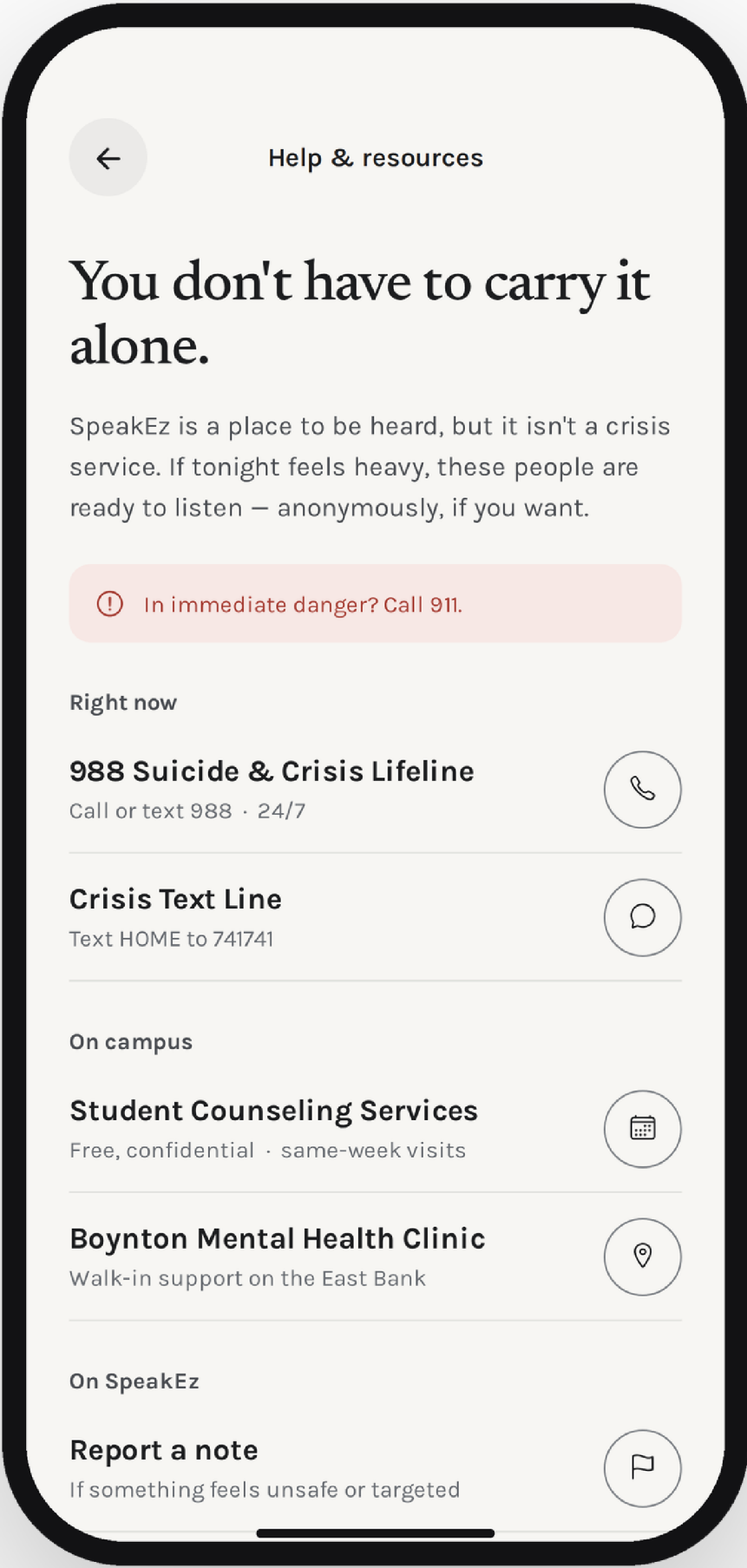
Hard moments get care, one tap away.

988, Crisis Text Line and Boynton Mental Health.

Threats are blocked. Posts go live after a short random delay.

So a note can't be tied to whoever just walked away.

PRIVACY & SAFETY



Built to ship.

01

Record

Expo app, iOS + Android

02

Transcribe

NVIDIA Parakeet on GPU

03

Safety gate

Live, held or blocked

04

Publish

FastAPI, Postgres, Redis

05

Unlock

PostGIS distance check

ACCESSIBILITY

Word-synced transcripts for Deaf and hard of hearing students. Voice first, screen reader labels, dark mode and cached audio for weak Wi-Fi.

SCALABILITY

Every campus is a new landmark layer. Stateless API, one-command Docker stack, storage moves to Cloudflare R2 by config.

RELIABILITY

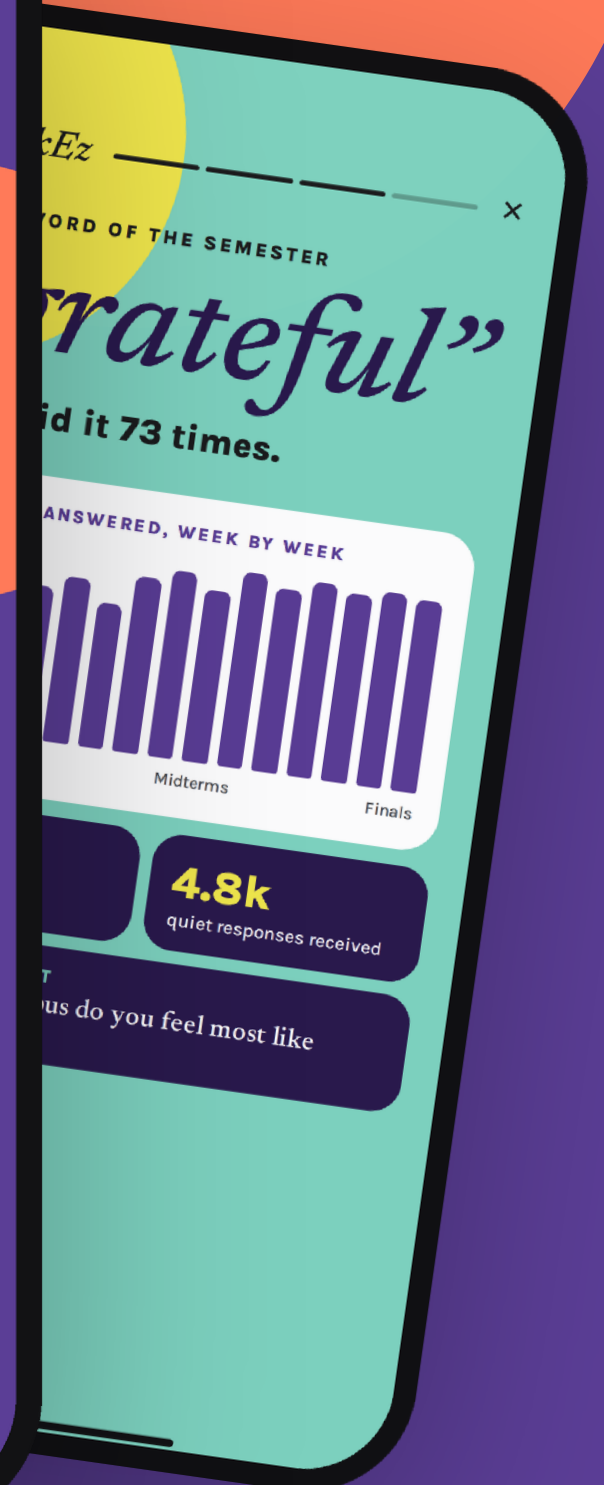
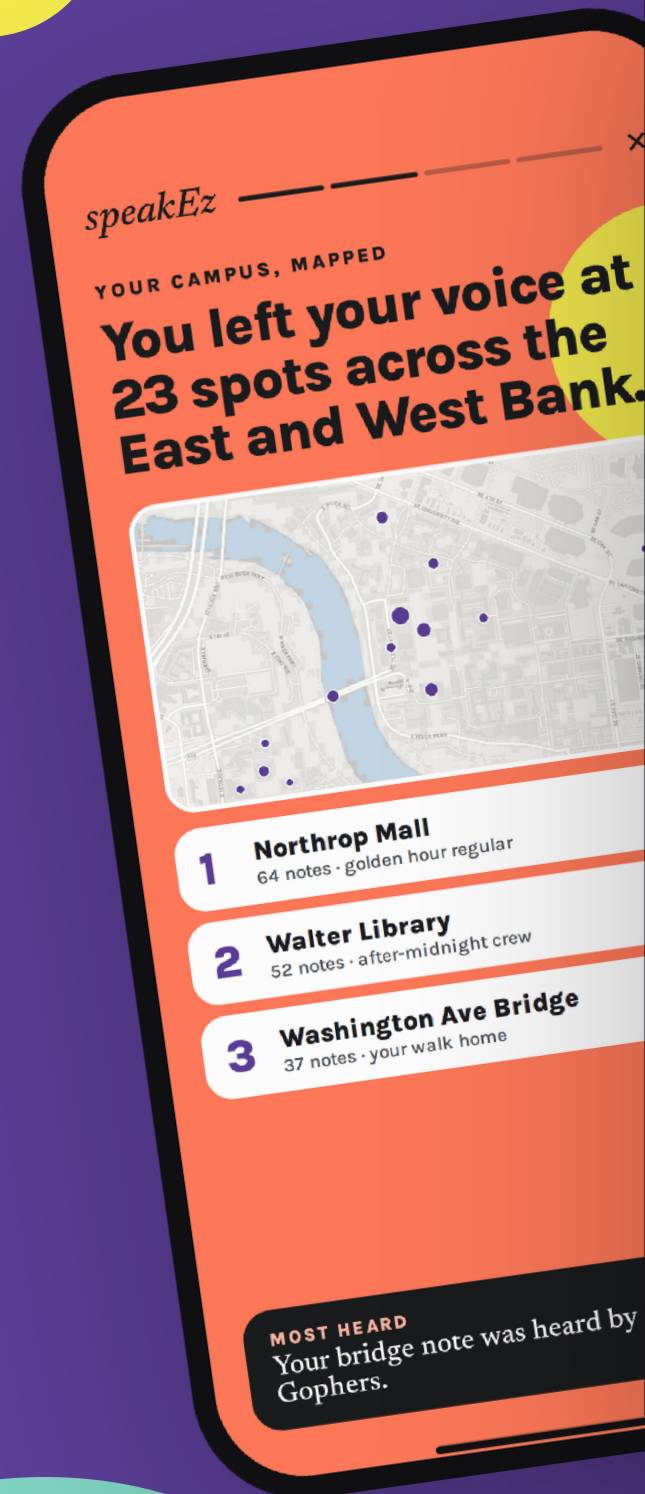
87 API tests across unlock, safety, publish and release, run in CI on every push. The server enforces every privacy rule.

Huge thanks to Lovable for the credits. We used it to organize our workspace :)

COMING NEXT

speakEz Wrapped.

Every semester ends with a story of your daily prompt answers. Swipe through it like a highlight reel of the moments you finally said out loud.



SPEAKEZ WRAPPED

Your semester, in your own voice.

104 days in a row you said it out loud.

418 notes, 9h 47m of your own voice, heard by 2,316 Gophers.

Your campus, mapped.

23 spots across the East and West Bank. Northrop Mall at golden hour, Walter after midnight, the bridge on your walk home.

Your word of the semester.

Your favorite prompt, your 58-day streak and every quiet response you received.

Look how far you came.

Your first note from Welcome Week next to your latest, replayed in your own voice. Private by default.



Say the thing you haven't said out loud.

BUILT BY
Team Wakehaven

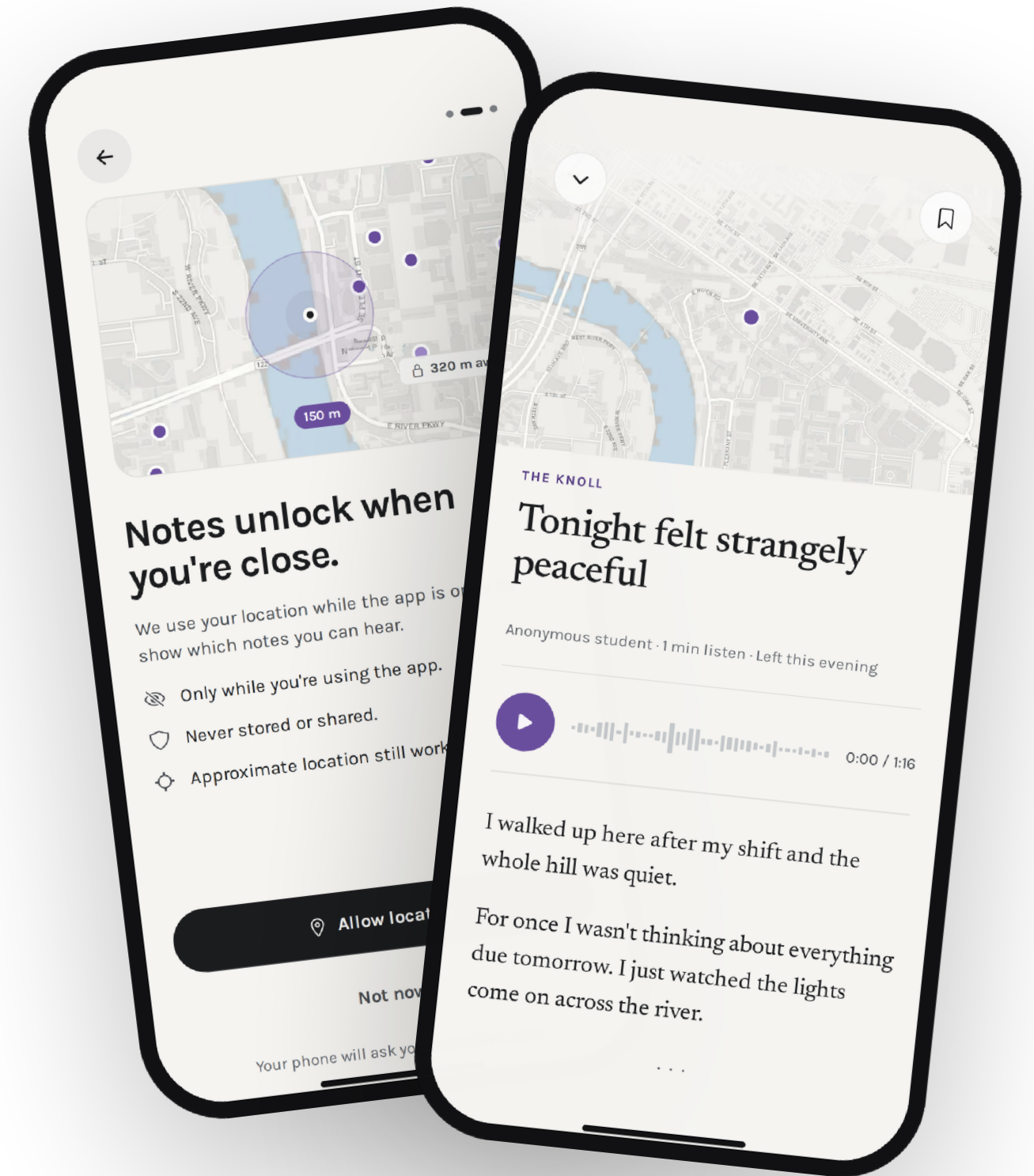
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